

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 38 Summary

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In this video, I cover the **imperative mood in Spanish**, which is used to give commands. You might also hear it referred to as the **command form**. Spanish has its own set of conjugations that make it crystal clear when someone is giving a command—something we don't really have in English, where it all depends on voice and tone. In Spanish, the verb form says it all.

1. What Is the Imperative?

The imperative lets us give direct instructions or orders.

Examples:

- *Siéntate.* = Sit down.
- *No te sientes.* = Don't sit down.

It only exists in the **present tense**, but it has different forms depending on who you're talking to and whether the command is **affirmative** or **negative**.

2. The Form You'll Use Most: Tú Commands

This is what you'll use the most—when talking to friends, family, or people you're close to.

A. Regular Verbs – Affirmative (Tú)

Take the present tense form for **tú** and drop the final **-s**.

- *Hablas* → *Habla*
- *Comes* → *Come*
- *Escribes* → *Escribe*

B. Regular Verbs – Negative (Tú)

Use the **present subjunctive** pattern:

- *No hables, no comas, no escribas*

C. Pronouns with Tú Commands

- **Affirmative:** Attach the pronouns to the end: *Póntela*.
- **Negative:** Place the pronouns before the verb: *No te la pongas*.

3. Common Irregular Tú Commands

Here are the irregulars I cover in the video. These show up constantly, so I recommend memorizing them.

Verb Tú Affirmative Tú Negative

hacer	haz	no	hagas
decir	di	no	digas
ir	ve	no	vayas
poner	pon	no	pongas
salir	sal	no	salgas
ser	sé	no	seas
tener	ten	no	tengas
venir	ven	no	vengas

Examples I used:

- *Hazlo ya.* = Do it now.
- *No lo hagas.* = Don't do it.

4. Formal Usted Commands

I also cover how to give polite or formal commands using **usted**. These follow the **present subjunctive** forms and are the same for both affirmative and negative commands.

- *Hable / No hable*
- *Coma / No coma*
- *Siéntese / No se siente*
- *Póngasela / No se la ponga*

5. Ustedes Commands (Group You)

Whether you're in Latin America or using formal Spanish in Spain, the **ustedes** commands follow the same pattern as **usted**, just with an **-n** at the end.

- *Hablen / No hablen*
- *Ponganla / No la pongan*
- *Vayanse / No se vayan*

This is used when talking to a group.

6. Vosotros Commands (Used in Spain Only)

I include this for those learning European Spanish.

A. Affirmative:

Drop the -r from the infinitive and add **-d**:

- *Hablad, comed, vivid*

B. Negative:

Use the present subjunctive with **vosotros** endings:

- *No habléis, no comáis, no salgáis*

With reflexives, the **-d** is dropped before adding **-os**:

- *Sentaos / No os sentéis*
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7. Nosotros Commands (“Let’s...”)

These are for suggesting actions you’ll do together.

Use the present subjunctive for both affirmative and negative:

- *Hablemos / No hablemos*
- *Comamos / No comamos*

You can also use **Vamos a + infinitive** as a more casual alternative:

- *Vamos a comer.* = Let’s eat.

With reflexives, Spanish drops the final **-s** before adding **-nos**:

- *Sentémonos / No nos sentemos*
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8. Object Pronoun Order

When you add object pronouns to commands, the order matters:

Reflexive → Indirect → Direct

Examples:

- *Póntela.* = Put it on.
 - *No te la pongas.* = Don't put it on.
 - *Díselo.* = Tell it to him/her.
 - *No se lo digas.* = Don't tell it to him/her.
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9. Final Tips

I recommend starting with the **tú commands**—you'll use them the most.

Learn the **common irregulars** early, and don't stress too much about *vosotros* unless you're focusing on Spain.